ONE-PAGE SUMMARY

JLR: The Business Case for Cyber Resilience

If a cyber attack will eventually get through, where should a car maker spend its next pound to limit the damage?

1. WHAT HAPPENED

A cyber attack in 2025 stopped Jaguar Land Rover's factories for five weeks, and profit almost disappeared.

£22.9bn
Sales in the year to March 2026, down from £29.0bn the year before.

£14m
Profit before tax and one-off costs, down from £2.5bn.

£2.6bn
Net debt, which is borrowing minus cash. A year earlier JLR held more cash than debt.

£260m
One-off cost of responding to the attack. No insurer paid any of it back.

2. WHERE THE LOSS CAME FROM

About three-quarters of the attack-related loss came from the length of the full stop.

About £2.6bn of the £6.1bn fall in sales was already under way.

Up to about £3.5bn of the fall is linked to the attack.

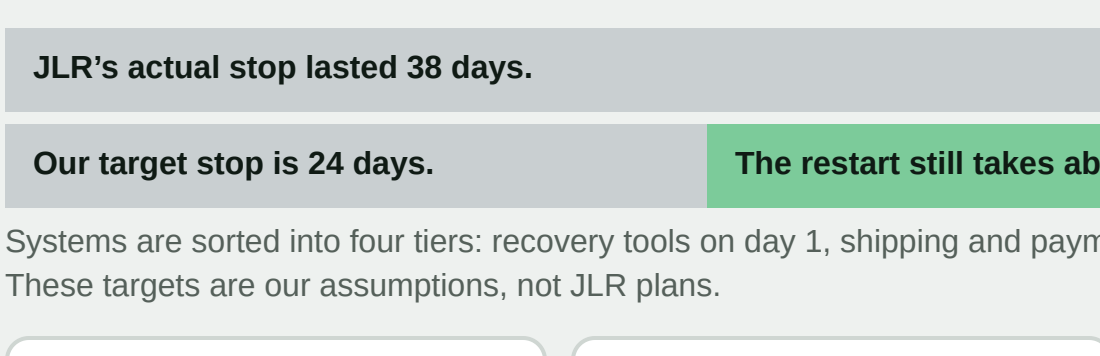
About 74% of the attack-related loss came from the full stop of about 5.4 weeks.

About 26% came from the slow restart.

One week of normal output is worth about £0.5bn of sales. These splits are our own estimates, and the full stop's true share could be anywhere from 61% to 86%.

3. THE FOUR OPTIONS WE SCORED

Option D scored highest, but only just ahead of option B.



Scores are out of 5 and reflect our judgement across six criteria. Insurance would win if the board gave low cost more than about 38% of the weight.

4. WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

In the central case, no option pays for itself.

Net benefit over three years, £m	Central	Higher risk
A. Prevention first	−100	−5
B. Recovery first	−39	**+72**
C. Insurance	−22	0
D. Recovery plus extras	−69	**+75**

A negative number means a net cost. The higher-risk case assumes a 30% chance of an attack within three years instead of 15%.

5. WHAT WOULD HAVE TO BE TRUE FOR OPTION B TO BREAK EVEN

34%
The chance of a JLR-sized attack in three years would need to be 34%, not the 15% we assumed.

3.9 weeks
The plan would need to save 3.9 weeks of production, not the 2 weeks we assumed.

£41m
The plan would need to cost £41m over three years, not the £80m we assumed.

6. THE DESIGN AND THE PLAN

Restoring systems in order of value could bring normal output back 14 days sooner, and spending is released in stages.

JLR's actual stop lasted 38 days.

The staged restart took 38 more days.

Our target stop is 24 days.

The restart still takes about 38 days.

Systems are sorted into four tiers: recovery tools on day 1, shipping and payments by day 7, production lines with first output on day 24, then everything else. These targets are our assumptions, not JLR plans.

Months 0 to 1.5
Phase 0: Decide and measure
£3m
Name owners and test today's recovery times.

Months 1.5 to 6
Phase 1: Build foundations
£15m
Build a protected recovery area and manual workarounds.

Months 6 to 18
Phase 2: Build and prove
£40m
Rehearse a full rebuild at two main plants.

Months 18 to 36
Phase 3: Roll out and maintain
£22m
Extend to all plants and rehearse every year.

£18m

The recommendation is to approve only Phases 0 and 1 now. Later phases should be paid for only if practice runs show enough saved production time: 2.9 weeks to approve Phase 2 and 3.9 weeks to approve Phase 3, assuming a 20% chance of an attack.

Independent analysis using public information only. Not affiliated with or endorsed by JLR or Tata Motors. Costs, probabilities, time savings and profit margin are illustrative placeholders, and scores are our judgement. Company facts come from JLR's Annual Report 2025/26 and Automotive World. The insurance position comes from Insurance Business UK (September 2026). The loss split and model results are our own calculations.